

PROFESSOR X

Mastermind of the X-Men

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FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Charles Francis Xavier

OCCUPATION

Mutant rights activist, teacher

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

6 ft

WEIGHT

190 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

None

FIRST APPEARANCE

Uncanny X-Men Vol. 1 #1

(September 1963)

POWERS

Vast psionic abilities including mind-reading, mind-erasing, astral projection, the projection of illusions, the ability to take mental control of others, and the ability to fire mental blasts.

ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES The X-Men, the Starjammers

FOES Magneto, Juggernaut, Cassandra Nova, the Sentinels, the Hellfire Club

ISSUE #1

In X-Men #1, Professor X's team unites to fight off the menace of Magneto, marking the first appearance of both the heroic X-Men and their arch-foe.



Growing up in a time before widespread superpowers, Charles Xavier hid his telepathic abilities to shield himself from unwanted attention.

FIRST LOVE

Xavier attended graduate school at Oxford University, England, where he fell in love with Moira MacTaggart; however their relationship ended when Charles joined the US Army. Following his tour of duty, Xavier traveled the world. At a clinic for Holocaust survivors in Israel, he befriended the man who would become MAGNETO. Magneto and Xavier teamed up to fight BARON VON STRUCKER, but Magneto's ruthless methods made it clear that the two had incompatible philosophies concerning the use of violence. Xavier left Israel, leaving behind Gabrielle HALLER, not realizing that Haller was pregnant with his child (the boy, David, would grow up to become the mutant LEGION). A rockslide caused by the villainous alien Lucifer, left Xavier a paraplegic.

THE X-MEN

As Professor X, Charles Xavier founded Xavier's School for Gifted Youngsters in Westchester County, New York to train mutant children in the use of their powers. Xavier identified potential students with the machine Cerebro, which amplified his telepathic powers and allowed him to pinpoint mutants from afar. His initial Super Hero team, the X-MEN, consisted of CYCLOPS, Angel (see ARCHANGEL), Marvel Girl (see JEAN GREY), Iceman and Beast, who sought to improve the image of mutants by selfless deeds.

Widely considered the most powerful mutant on Earth, Charles Xavier has dedicated his life to the ideal that humans and mutants can coexist peacefully. His father Brian died when Charles was a child. Kurt Marko, his father's research partner, married Charles's mother Sharon, but only valued her for her fortune. Charles became a rival of his stepbrother Cain (who one day gained the powers of the JUGGERNAUT), and saw both his mother and stepfather die in separate incidents.



Professor X can disable opponents, such as the Juggernaut, with mental blasts.



The X-Men repeatedly faced off against Magneto, who had dedicated himself to subjugating humanity through his powers as the master of magnetism.

Professor X founded a second team of X-Men, whose members included NIGHTCRAWLER, COLOSSUS, STORM, BANSHEE, and WOLVERINE. The X-Men helped Xavier battle Shi'ar emperor D'Ken and the Imperial Guard. Xavier then fell in love with the new Shi'ar empress, Lilandra. He entered into the Shi'ar equivalent of marriage with Lilandra, and adventured with the STARJAMMERS.



Although his love for Shi'ar empress Lilandra took him across the galaxy, Professor X eventually returned to the X-Men.

Back on Earth, Xavier organized a third grouping of students, the NEW MUTANTS, but fell under the influence of the alien Brood. To prevent his transformation into a Brood Queen, Xavier shifted his consciousness into a clone body with fully-functional legs. After suffering injuries as a result of a hate crime, Xavier reunited with Lilandra to recuperate among the Shi'ar, leaving Magneto to run the academy in his absence. Xavier again lost the use of his legs battling the SHADOW KING, and brought together a fourth team of young mutants, GENERATION X.

The relationship between Magneto and Xavier took a turn for the worse, culminating in a terrible moment when Magneto ripped the adamantium from Wolverine's skeleton. Enraged by Magneto's brutality, Xavier mind-wiped his former friend, unwittingly creating a powerful psionic being known as ONSLAUGHT. All of Earth's heroes united to destroy Onslaught, leading to the apparent deaths of the AVENGERS and the FANTASTIC FOUR. In the aftermath, Xavier briefly lost his telepathic powers and became a prisoner of the US government. He later uncovered a SKRULL plot to infiltrate the X-Men, and trained a promising group of Skrull mutants calling themselves Cadre K.



Professor X designed the Danger Room, not realizing it would develop a mind of its own.

was the self-aware consciousness of the X-Mansion's Danger Room training center, a fact that Xavier had known but suppressed in order to hone his students' combat skills.

Xavier tried to help Magneto's daughter, the SCARLET WITCH, recover from a breakdown, but he was unable to prevent her from removing the power from most mutants—including himself—on M-Day. With the reemergence of VULCAN, Xavier and a team of X-Men track him to the Shi'ar Empire. They fail to stop Vulcan, but being



BATTLING MAGNETO

The philosophies held by Professor X and Magneto are diametrically opposed, but share some similarities. Both men profess the goal of protecting mutantkind, but Magneto wants to subjugate or eliminate human opposition, while Professor X dreams of a world where humans and mutants can co-exist. After Professor X founded the X-Men, Magneto created the Brotherhood of Evil Mutants. Over the years, the two men have been friends and foes. Recently, the pair united to help rebuild the island nation of Genosha. The Scarlet Witch's manipulations of reality during the House of M event seem to have temporarily de-powered both men.



TRANSITIONS

Xavier's genetic twin, the sinister Cassandra Nova, had died in Sharon Xavier's womb yet somehow maintained her life-essence. Nova re-entered Xavier's life with spectacular malevolence, orchestrating the devastation of the mutant nation of Genosha, and taking mental control of Xavier. In Xavier's guise, she outed him as a mutant to the world, and incited the Shi'ar Imperial Guard to attack the X-Mansion. Xavier's students helped free him from Nova's influence, and Xavier regained the use of his legs through the actions of academy student Xorn (actually a Magneto impostor in disguise.) Xavier later founded the

X-Corporation, stepping down as head of the academy. He lost the use of his legs when the Magneto impostor revealed himself, and left for Genosha to help the real Magneto rebuild that island's society.

An artificial lifeform Danger tracked down Xavier on Genosha, intent on killing him. During the battle, it became clear that Danger

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Giant-Size X-Men #1** Professor X recruits a new batch of X-Men to replace the originals, welcoming such future favorites as Nightcrawler and Storm.
- **New X-Men #118-126** The "Imperial" storyarc sees Professor X's genetic twin, Cassandra Nova, impersonating Xavier to imperil the Shi'ar empire.
- **Astonishing X-Men #7-12** A failure from his past returns to haunt Professor X, as he confronts the self-aware consciousness of the X-Men's Danger Room.
- **X-Men: Mutant Genesis, tpb** The X-Men stand in the way of Magneto's world-conquering schemes.

temporarily absorbed into the M'Kraan Crystal restore's Xavier's powers.

As a member of the ILLUMINATI, Xavier faced the HULK's wrath during World War Hulk (see pp. 150-1), but the Hulk came to believe that M-Day had cost the mutant enough. During the hunt for the first mutant baby born since M-Day, BISHOP accidentally shot Xavier in the head, putting him into a coma. He recovered but had lost much of his memory and so began the process of piecing his life back together.

PS, MF



When the Illuminati were captured by the Skrulls, the aliens subjected them to all kinds of experiments. Professor X proved one of the "easiest to explore."

